

# Philip Amalong

Behavior Change Content, Editorial Systems & Practical AI

Most of my work starts with the same question: what will help a person make the better choice when attention, motivation or energy gives way? I turn research and audience insight into clear content, then build the systems that keep the work accurate across channels.

## Content, Brand & Audience Growth Leader

VP Marketing at Freedom. Working producer, editor and builder of behavior-change technology.

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4M+

Freedom users

\$5M

ARR growth from launch

60

Freedom Matters episodes

25+

AI systems and tools shipped

## CONTENT LEADERSHIP

### Behavior-change content at scale

For nearly a decade at Freedom, I have led content and audience work around attention, digital wellbeing and healthier technology habits.

- Set editorial direction across the blog, newsletter, lifecycle and product copy, App Store content, social, video, partnerships and research-led campaigns.
- Hired and managed staff, writers, creators, contractors and agencies, while building the briefs, calendar and review process behind the work.
- Created and produced [Freedom Matters](#), a 60-episode series featuring more than 60 writers, researchers and thinkers.
- Worked with product, design, engineering, customer success and analytics so content supported product use and retention as well as reach.

The best behavior-change content gives the reader a step they can take now. It explains enough of the research to earn trust and never turns a difficult habit into

a moral failure.

## EDITORIAL SYSTEMS AND PRACTICAL AI

# Use technology to improve judgment, not replace it

My AI work focuses on research, editorial consistency, competitive intelligence and useful product interventions. Nothing publishes autonomously.

### 01 / DISCOVERABILITY

#### AEO Watchdog

Tracks Freedom's appearance in AI answers, identifies citation gaps, maps them to live content and stages specific fixes for human review.

[View Freedom's open knowledge files](#)

### 02 / PRODUCT CONCEPT

#### Freedom Focus Coach

Uses session context to identify what is blocking progress and help a person shrink the task instead of ending a focus session.

*Product concept and working prototype*

### 03 / ADAPTIVE AUDIO

#### Sage

Generates low-salience focus music for the exact length of a work session, avoiding loops and sudden changes before resolving at the end.

*Internal product concept and working prototype*

### HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

## Editorial knowledge that carries into the next assignment

Voice standards, product truth, research, decision history and lessons from past mistakes live in shared tools rather than one person's memory.

- **Automate repeat work:** scheduled reports, scoring and collection.
- **Start with evidence:** reviews, product use, cohort data and named sources.
- **Keep review visible:** stage drafts, decide deliberately and measure after publication.
- **Turn mistakes into rules:** corrected failures become documented guardrails.

## SELECTED WRITING

# Research translation, point of view and long-form argument

These pieces show different parts of the work: making research useful, taking a clear position, explaining a product and sustaining a complex argument.

**FREEDOM · JUNE 2026**

## **AI Brain Rot: What It Is, What the MIT Study Found, and How to Fix It**

A research-led article about cognitive offloading and practical ways to use AI without handing over the thinking.

**LINKEDIN · DECEMBER 2016**

## **Mute the Dashboard and Do Something**

A direct essay for marketers about the difference between measuring work and doing it.

**MEDIUM · JANUARY 2021**

## **Why Do Musicians Make Music?**

A long-form analysis of streaming economics, artist value and a more equitable industry model.

**FREEDOM · APRIL 2026**

## **From Study to Headline: Freedom in The Washington Post**

Turns a published digital-behavior study and major media coverage into a clear story for a broad audience.

**FREEDOM · APRIL 2016**

## **Productivity's Ultimate Reward: The Joy of Creating**

An early point of view on focus, creative work and why productivity is worth pursuing.

**FREEDOM · APRIL 2023**

## **Generative AI and the ARC of Happiness**

An interview-led piece on autonomy, relatedness, competence and using generative AI thoughtfully.

▼ **View the complete Freedom writing index**

[Productivity's Ultimate Reward: The Joy of Creating](#)

[How to Block Pokémon Go](#)

[MANIFESTO](#)

[5 Ambient Sound Apps for Focus and Productivity](#)

[Focus Better with Freedom's Website Exceptions Feature](#)

[How to Block Websites on Chromebooks and Linux Devices](#)

[COVID-19: Free Work-From-Home Resources for Focus and Calm](#)

[New Focus Sounds: Now on the Freedom Dashboard](#)

[Free Focus Music](#)

[Free Timer for Work and Study](#)

[Free Coffee Shop Sounds](#)

[Generative AI and the ARC of Happiness](#)

[How to Block Ads with Freedom](#)

[The 4-Hour Workweek and Freedom](#)

[Freedom vs BePresent](#)

[From Study to Headline: Freedom in The Washington Post](#)

[AI Brain Rot](#)

[View the Freedom author archive](#)

**AUDIO AND MUSIC**

# Editorial judgment expressed through sound

My audio work ranges from interview production and original scoring to functional music and playlist curation. The same concerns apply: pacing, attention, emotional shape and what the audience needs next.

**PODCAST**

## **Freedom Matters**

Created and produced 60 episodes, including guest development, interviews, editing, original theme music and episode scoring.

**BROADCAST**

## **Sonark Sessions: Live from the Barn**

Co-producer of a public-television performance series, covering booking, artist relationships, partner management and delivery.

**FUNCTIONAL MUSIC**

## **Focus music and adaptive sound**

Developed and curated music intended to support concentration without demanding it, including Freedom Focus Music and Sage.

### Curated Spotify playlist 01

[Open in Spotify](#)

### Curated Spotify playlist 02

[Open in Spotify](#)

### Curated Spotify playlist 03

[Open in Spotify](#)

#### LEADERSHIP AND DELIVERY

## Clear standards, useful context and hands-on work

- Built a seven-person product marketing team at ReverbNation and managed staff, contractors, agencies and creative partners at Freedom.
- Spent ten years as a professor and department chair, then co-founded a creator education platform acquired by Steinway.
- Worked across product, engineering, customer success, executives, researchers, artists, brands, labels, orchestras and broadcast partners.
- Stay close enough to edit the difficult paragraph, question the claim or help find the right structure.

#### CONTACT

## Let's talk about the work.

Based in Chapel Hill, North Carolina. Available by email, phone or LinkedIn.